4 Django ORM

This chapter covers

- Interacting with a database through the Django ORM
- Creating objects that map to database tables
- Querying the database
- Building object relationships
- Loading and storing content through fixtures

This chapter introduces you to Django's *object relational mapping* (ORM), an object-oriented abstraction for interacting with databases. Django provides a way to create, read, update, and delete both data and tables in a database to add storage capabilities to your website.

4.1 Interacting with a database

Until now, RiffMates has been composed of mostly static content. You learned how to write views that are called when a user visits a URL, and inside those views, you created small dictionaries to provide context for rendering templates. Hardcoding data dictionaries in a view is rather limited. Most websites have a storage layer that is queried inside the view. Storage gets used for